



Gate & reception — appointments, vehicles, and access control in one place.

This guide records the work done to close incomplete visit cycles and fix the desk/gate UX holes that left visits stuck. Use it as a walkthrough for hosts, reception, and gate staff after deploy.

What was broken

- Hosts could invite a visitor but had no way to cancel a booking from the app.
- Expected / approved visits that never arrived stayed open forever (no no-show / expire).
- Reception checkout stopped at checked_out. Without a gate confirm, the visit never reached completed.
- A new gate vehicle visit was stored as expected while the vehicle was already on_site — occupancy and visit status disagreed.
- Gate / desk check-in and the station New Visitor form could submit with no host.
- Station visit detail was read-only, overdue visits hid reception actions, kiosk success left pass codes on screen, and checkout fired with one tap.
- Invite Visitor existed as a page but was missing from the host sidebar.
- The transition graph included a fake status named queue that is not a real visit status.

Happy path now

Host invite !' expected or pending_approval !' (optional) arrived_at_gate !' reception_check_in !' waiting !' in_meeting !' checked_out !' left_premises !' completed.

- Reception checkout always completes the visit: checked_out then left_premises then completed, including guests who arrived at a gate.
- Confirm left remains available for any leftover checked_out rows from before this change.
- Past expected / approved bookings with a passed appointment window are marked expired by a background worker.
- Any visit still open after 12 hours (from check-in, or created_at at the gate) is auto-completed: checkout, vehicles exited, then completed.
- Pre-arrival bookings can be cancelled by the host or reception with a confirmation dialog.

What each role can do now

Host

- Invite Visitor is in the sidebar.
- Cancel a booking from visit detail or appointments (confirm dialog).
- Approve / reject reception requests as before.
- On-site list stays read-only — exit is still desk or gate.

Reception

- Cancel expected bookings from logs or detail.
- Checkout asks to confirm badge return.
- Desk-only visits complete on checkout.
- Confirm left closes leftover checked_out rows.
- Overdue visits show Check out as the action.

Gate / station

- Host is required on walk-in, vehicle, and New Visitor.
- New vehicle visits start as arrived_at_gate.
- Visit detail now has check-in, check-out, confirm left.
- Checkout / confirm left use a confirmation dialog.

Kiosk visitor

- Check-in / check-out success screens clear after 8 seconds.
- Pass code and badge are not left for the next person.
- Footer copy now matches that behaviour.



Demo accounts

- Password for all @demo.org users: demo1234. Super admin: admin@template.dev / admin123.
- host@demo.org — Host calendar, invite, approvals, visitor logs.
- reception@demo.org — Reception calendar, check-in desk, visitor logs. Needs a linked receptionist profile.
- gate@demo.org — Station dashboard, gate check-in / checkout, visitor logs.
- Kiosk: open /kiosk (no staff login).

Suggested walkthrough

- Host: Invite Visitor !' confirm it appears on Appointments / Visitor Logs !' Cancel one booking and confirm the dialog.
- Host: leave a second invite active so reception can receive it.
- Reception: Expected tab or Visitor Logs !' Check in / Receive at desk !' Queue to host !' Check out (confirm badge) !' visit should show Completed.
- Reception: overdue rows now offer Check out. Leftover checked_out rows offer Confirm left.
- Gate: Expected arrivals !' check in a guest (host required) !' open the visit from logs and check out or confirm left.
- Gate: Vehicle entry creates the visit as arrived_at_gate so it appears on occupancy and the exit list.
- Kiosk: check in, then wait ~8 seconds — the pass code screen must return to /kiosk by itself.

Status meanings after this change

- cancelled — host or reception closed a pre-arrival booking. Terminal.
- expired — appointment window passed and the guest never checked in. Set by the expire worker. Terminal.
- checked_out — brief desk-exit step. Reception checkout immediately continues to left_premises and completed.
- left_premises / completed — physically off site. Occupancy and host availability are cleared.
- overdue — still on site past the category duration. Reception primary action is now Check out.
- denied is still unused. Watchlist blocks do not create a visit record yet.

Technical notes for engineers

- Cancel: applyVisitCancel() in server/visitCancel.js. Host POST /admin/host/visits/:id/cancel. Reception POST /admin/reception/visits/:id/cancel. Shared helper isCancelEligible() in shared/visitCancel.js.
- Expire: markExpiredVisits() in server/visitExpire.js, scheduled from server/index.js (EXPIRED_VISIT_INTERVAL_MS, default 60s). Only approved / expected with a past expected_at or appointment.scheduled_at and no checked_in_at.
- Auto-complete: autoCompleteStateVisits() in server/visitAutoComplete.js. Default 12 hours (AUTO_COMPLETE_VISIT_HOURS). Also runs when security/station dashboards load.
- Reception checkout always calls finalizeVisitDeparture() so the visit reaches completed at the desk.
- Gate vehicle insert status is arrived_at_gate (server/routes/visitor.js). Linked expected visits still transition when allowed.

- VISIT_TRANSITIONS no longer includes the invalid queue token. expected and entered_premises now list waiting / pending_approval (and expected can cancel).
- Tests: tests/visitExpire.test.js, tests/visitExit.test.js, tests/reception.test.js, tests/scope.test.js, tests/portalLock.test.js.

Out of scope this pass

- Watchlist “denied entry” visit records and the unused denied status.
- entered_premises as a separate gate UI step.
- Design.md extras: badge reconcile, deliveries, emergency zone view, mobile bottom nav.
- Pagination / silent empty-list toasts on visitor logs.

How to run locally

- `cp .env.example .env` then `npm install`.
- Create MySQL database wgvf. If another app already uses port 4000, start this API with `PORT=4001`.
- `npm run server:start` and `npm run dev`.
- Optional: `npm run seed:portal-users`.
- Regenerate this PDF: `node server/scripts/generateVisitCycleGuidePdf.js`.